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“I know that by forwarding these so-called humorous e-mails I may offend or tick off people who do not share my sense of humour or who are sick of having stupid e-mails forwarded to them each time a Newbie hops online.”

There! Now, that wasn't too bad, was it? Hopefully, you will no longer be tempted to forward those jokes, untruthful or frivolous e-mail that instruct you to forward them to your friends! And you'll avoid looking silly and uninformed in the process. Read them if you must, then hit 'Delete'. You don't believe those e-mails that state that certain things will happen simply by you forwarding the e-mail to 10 friends, do you?

In addition, many of these e-mails are hoaxes or downright bogus. Before you forward an e-mail that appears good-intentioned with an incredible story that instructs you to “read and share” with everyone you know, you might want to first check www.snopes.com to see if the story is legitimate in the first place. Not doing so can have you eating crow when everyone you e-mail is informed you just forwarded a hoax without knowing better. And, don't get mad at someone if they point out to you that you were uninformed by perpetuating a hoax! If you don't know for a fact that the e-mail you're forwarding is accurate and specifically apropos to the person you are forwarding to and you know they will want to receive it—all you have to do is ask first.

6. Never give out phone numbers or personal information without confirming you are communicating with a reputable party. Never give out personal contact information of others without their specific permission to do so.
7. Make a reasonable effort to search a Web site for the information you are looking for—‘Frequently Asked Questions’ or